

Firstly, congratulations on being selected to serve as the Sustainability Director for this year's Jester East Residence Hall Council. You've clearly demonstrated commitment to the community, and this role allows you to shape the daily experience of hundreds of residents. The main purpose of the Residence Hall Council is to advocate for your fellow residents and your work does that through environmental stewardship, food-security support, and sustainable community building. Jester East depends on you to help create a living environment where students feel supported, informed, and empowered to make choices that benefit both themselves and the planet.

The Sustainability Director's purpose is to ensure that Jester East remains a community grounded in responsible resource use, waste reduction, and accessible sustainability education. You serve as the primary point of contact for all sustainability-related initiatives, and your work often intersects with wellness, community engagement, and student support. You will collaborate closely with the Executive Board, advisors, and campus partners to bring programs to life and to ensure that sustainability is woven into the culture of the hall. You've already served on the council, so you understand the rhythm of meetings, programming, and communication, and this role builds on that foundation.

It is important that you stay in consistent communication with the President, Vice President, and your council's Advisor so that any sustainability updates, needs, or initiatives are included in meeting agendas and planning conversations. You will often be the one providing insight on how events can be made more environmentally responsible or how resources can be used more efficiently. You should also share any information you receive from campus sustainability partners such as the Office of Sustainability, Zero Waste Program, or UT Farm Stand that could benefit residents or support council programming. You are the point person for this portfolio, and the board will rely on you to be available, organized, and knowledgeable.

Mastering Roomcompact will be important for you as well, since you will use it to submit event proposals, track supplies, and coordinate with advisors. You are responsible for making sure that funding requests and events planned are feasible and this applies directly to your role. You will often be the one determining whether a sustainability initiative is realistic, whether supplies are available, and whether the event aligns with Housing & Dining guidelines. Jester East has the resources to support meaningful sustainability programming, and those resources should be used generously when they directly benefit residents and promote responsible living.

As Sustainability Director, one of your most important responsibilities is leading sustainability-focused programs. This includes food-waste reduction efforts, resource-sharing initiatives, educational campaigns, and at least one major sustainability event each year. You may run programs like leftover food redistribution, composting education, clothing swaps, hygiene kit distributions, or sustainable living fairs. You will also maintain inventory of sustainability supplies and ensure that materials are used responsibly and replenished when needed. Your work directly affects residents' quality of life, especially those who rely on resource-access programs.

Delegation is essential. While you lead the sustainability portfolio, you are not expected to do everything alone. Work with committee members, collaborate with other halls or organizations, and rely on volunteers when needed. Everyone on the board is capable of fulfilling their responsibilities, and your job is to guide, not to carry the entire load. You will develop your own leadership style, and you should trust yourself as you grow into the role. As long as you are doing what you believe is best for the residents of Jester East, you can be confident that you are doing the job well.